

John L. Radford

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1.1 Summary

DevOps engineer and systems programmer with 6+ years at a production web hosting company. Builds internal tooling, automation, and infrastructure end-to-end — from distributed KVM clusters to custom RAG pipelines. Writes production Perl and Python, owns Linux systems, and ships full-stack internal tools.

1.2 Technical Skills

Languages: Perl, Python, Bash, JavaScript

Infra & Ops: Linux (RHEL/Ubuntu/FreeBSD), QEMU/KVM, Puppet, Ansible, Nginx, Apache, ELK Stack

Data & Caching: MySQL/MariaDB, Redis, ChromaDB

Security & Networking: SOC/SIEM, VPN, rate limiting, IP threat intelligence, HMAC auth

Tools: GitLab CI/CD, Netbox, CloudLinux, Icinga2, SureMDM, REST APIs, Plack/PSGI

1.3 Work Experience

1.3.1 DevOps Specialist & Systems Administrator — Pair Networks, Inc.

2023 – 2026

- Built a **Virtual Resource Manager** (Perl): per-host REST API agents broadcasting live CPU/mem/guest stats, a weighted-average rebalancing algorithm, and an interactive REPL CLI (`vrnctl`) for manipulating the QEMU/KVM cluster.
- Developed a **custom RAG pipeline** (Python): ingested docs from GitLab, wikis, and knowledge bases; chunked, vectorized, and stored in ChromaDB; deployed tailored internal LLMs to assist support staff.
- Built a **centralized IP threat intelligence system**: Perl modules querying multiple public threat APIs, persisted to a central store with Redis caching to minimize redundant external calls.
- Developed a **Zendesk webhook API** (Perl Plack, HMAC-verified): auto-populated ticket fields from a username or account number, eliminating manual lookup for the entire support team.
- Integrated **Nginx/Apache rate limiting** into the Puppet build system; built a web stats pipeline for false-positive monitoring and threshold tuning.
- Developed a **KPI metrics pipeline**: automated collection of core business metrics from billing and account systems into a central database, replacing ad-hoc executive reporting.

1.3.2 NOC & Security Technician — Pair Networks, Inc.

2020 – 2023

- Promoted to concurrent Security and NOC roles: monitored, detected, and remediated intrusions; triaged live production server incidents (hardware and software).
- Simultaneously handled Level 2 support, abuse team, and internal account migrations.

1.3.3 Support Technician — Pair Networks, Inc.

2018 – 2020

- Resolved customer issues across web hosting, email, DNS, databases, and PHP.
- Built deep Linux hosting expertise that underpins all subsequent engineering roles.

1.4 Open Source

Web-LGSM — web portal for managing Linux game servers

Term::ReadLine::Repl — published CPAN REPL module; used in production `vrnctl` tooling

Acme::Shotgun — published CPAN module

1.5 Education

University of Pittsburgh — B.A., Humanities; Minor in Political Science (2017)